

It wasn't long before Heimdall returned with the Thunder God, by which time Hrungrir was shouting "Wretched, puny Aesir!" at the top of his lungs and smashing tables with his anvil-sized fists.

"How dare you disrespect our hall with such loutish behaviour," Thor cried, brandishing Mjölner. "I will strike you dead where you stand!"

"You'd kill an unarmed opponent?" Hrungrir said, holding out his empty hands. "That's not very noble for a mighty god like you. How about a proper fight, at dawn tomorrow?"

Thor accepted immediately. "I can hardly wait," he growled.

They met next morning on a plain of dew-sprinkled grass. Clad in stone armour, carrying a stone shield and wielding a huge whetstone, Hrungrir, who had a head and heart of stone, looked more fearsome than ever. "Ready?" he boomed.

*Lightning flickered across the Thunder God's brow.
"Always," he said softly.*

At the exact same moment, each threw their weapon at the other... And Mjölner struck Hrungrir right between the eyes. Death was instant and the ground shuddered as the giant fell.

